No Cheat Day In 4 Years (It's Not Discipline)

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 12, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/_pzaJn_ayP4 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter argues that eliminating cheat days entirely requires less discipline than having them, because cheat days trigger multi-day cravings, while full abstinence eventually kills the desire for junk food altogether.

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🍕 The Problem with Cheat Days 0:00

- Used to do cheat days like most people, telling himself "one cheat day, I'll be all right"
- The core problem: the day after a cheat day, cravings returned and intensified
  - Required **2–3 days of active discipline** after every cheat day just to get back on track
  - The cycle repeated every week: cheat on Sunday → cravings Monday through Wednesday → cravings finally fade → cheat again next Sunday
- He emphasizes he wasn't lacking willpower — he did abstain during those 2–3 days — but the cycle itself was the problem

🚫 The Decision to Quit Cheat Days 0:24

- Grew tired of the repeating "charade" and asked himself what would happen if he simply stopped having cheat days entirely
- Action taken: threw away and removed all cheat foods from his house completely
- Result after a few weeks: "I don't even want that food anymore. Like, I don't even want it."
  - The cravings disappeared because there was nothing periodically re-triggering them

💡 Abstinence vs. Moderation 0:46

- Key insight: **abstinence is easier than moderation**
- When people hear he hasn't had a cheat day in 4 years, they assume extreme discipline is the reason
- His reframe: he is actually using *less* discipline than someone who does cheat days
  - Cheat days force you to repeatedly re-engage discipline after every indulgence

    - Full elimination removes the trigger, so discipline is rarely needed

      > "Discipline is for amateurs. I do not want to have to use discipline except for emergencies."

- The goal is to engineer your environment and habits so desire itself is eliminated — not to white-knuckle through cravings repeatedly